

one thing, we don't all have the same experiences surrounding money. In between all the stereotypes are the forgotten: poor and working-class millennials.

Nona Willis Aronowitz, a friend and fellow reporter, has spent the past five years covering working-class millennials and poverty because she became frustrated by publications run by baby boomers publishing stories with photos of young people absentmindedly taking selfies or staring at themselves in the mirror.

One example: *Time* magazine's controversial "ME ME ME Generation" 2013 cover story struck her as particularly out of touch, postrecession. The story presented millennials in a limited way—as solely upper middle class.

"Actual working-class millennials, in the media, are not portrayed as millennials at all," she said in a phone interview. "They're just portrayed as poor people."

This is key. The generational term largely excludes people of color, lower-class people, young people from areas in the South and Midwest ("Real America"), and those who are all three. Are you really going to sit on your East Coast upper-class baby boomer high horse and call a Latinx 25-year-old low-income, single mother working two minimum wage jobs in rural Texas "lazy" or "entitled"?

Aronowitz didn't pull punches, calling this whole narrative "classist bullshit." The prevalent cliché of millennials is that we expect everything to be handed to us, but there are plenty of young people who never expected to do well or to have any help from their teachers, their government, or any support network that they were supposed to be able to count on—let alone feel entitled to anything.

"Most working-class and poor young people in this country are just constantly bumping up against institutions that are failing them and against increasingly fragile families and an unstable job market. It's just ridiculously low wages, an economy that they have no hope of climbing out of, and it's really not about entitlement or expectations at all," Aronowitz said. "They have such low expectations of themselves and their families in the first place. And that's the real tragedy."

Some, she said, don't even know the term *millennial*. Even if they're in the supermarket and incidentally see, let's say, the *Time* magazine cover about